A One-Person Flying Machine Meets a Giant Rocket

From: Space.com Mined: 2026-11-10 5 min read

A tiny flying machine **hovered** in the sky at NASA's Kennedy Space Center in Florida, with a giant rocket towering behind it. The photograph, Space.com's space photo of the day for November 9, shows two very different ideas about flight side by side. In front is the Jetson ONE, a single-person **electric aircraft** built by Jetson, a company based in the United States. Behind it stands the upper stage of Blue Origin's huge New Glenn rocket.

The scene was captured during the MAX POWER event, which brought together **innovators** and emerging technologies at the famous spaceflight center. The Jetson ONE was performing flight **demonstrations** during the UP.Summit gathering, which formed part of the larger event. Spectators watched as the little aircraft moved through the air and **hovered** in place, giving them a close-up look at the technology in action. It is a striking contrast.

Jetson is developing small **electric aircraft** designed for personal transportation, the kind of flying machine one person might use to travel short distances. New Glenn, on the other hand, is built to carry **payloads** far beyond Earth's atmosphere. One machine is made for a single rider. The other is made to leave the planet. Together, they show how flight can mean very different things: a quiet hover over a runway, or a thundering climb toward space. For now, the Jetson ONE is showing off what personal flight could look like in the future. But in this one photograph, the future of flight and the future of space travel share the same sky.

Word Treasure

hovered -- Stayed still in the air in one place.

electric aircraft -- A flying machine that runs on electricity instead of fuel.

payloads -- The cargo or equipment that a rocket carries into space.

innovators -- People who come up with new ideas and new ways of doing things.

demonstrations -- Public shows of how something works.

Background you need

NASA's Kennedy Space Center in Florida is one of the most famous places in the world for launching rockets into space.

The Jetson ONE is a new kind of small aircraft that runs on electricity and carries just one person, made for short trips.

New Glenn is a large rocket built to carry heavy loads far beyond Earth's atmosphere.

Events like MAX POWER bring together people working on new technology so the public can see it up close.

Break it down

LEAD: A tiny one-person flying machine hovered at NASA's Kennedy Space Center, with a giant rocket towering behind it.

KEY EVENT: The photograph of the Jetson ONE and New Glenn

+- IN FRONT: The Jetson ONE, a single-person electric aircraft built by Jetson, a company based in the United States.

+- BEHIND: The upper stage of Blue Origin's huge New Glenn rocket.

+- WHEN: The photo was Space.com's space photo of the day for November 9, taken during the MAX POWER event.

EVIDENCE: Spectators watched the Jetson ONE move through the air and hover in place during flight demonstrations at the UP.Summit gathering.

CONTRAST: One machine is made for a single rider on short trips; the other is made to carry payloads far beyond Earth's atmosphere.

OPEN QUESTION: What personal flight could look like in the future.

Why it matters

New kinds of flight could change how people travel short distances one day, and seeing a tiny personal aircraft next to a giant rocket shows how the same idea, flying, can grow in very different directions.

Test what you remember

1. Where did the Jetson ONE fly?

- (A) NASA's Kennedy Space Center in Florida
- (B) An airport in Texas
- (C) A beach in California
- (D) A field in New York

2. How many people is the Jetson ONE made to carry?

- (A) Ten
- (B) Four
- (C) One
- (D) Two

3. What stood behind the Jetson ONE in the photo?

- (A) A passenger airplane
- (B) A hot air balloon
- (C) The upper stage of Blue Origin's New Glenn rocket
- (D) A space shuttle

4. What was the Jetson ONE doing during the UP.Summit?

- (A) Performing flight demonstrations
- (B) Racing against the rocket
- (C) Carrying passengers to space
- (D) Being taken apart

5. What is New Glenn built to carry?

- (A) Cars across the ocean
- (B) Payloads far beyond Earth's atmosphere
- (C) People on short trips
- (D) Mail between cities

6. What was the photograph named?

- (A) NASA's photo of the month
- (B) Photo of the year
- (C) Space.com's space photo of the day for November 9
- (D) The best rocket photo ever

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: C 3: C 4: A 5: B 6: C

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):